

Appleby et al 2020 RG Notes

Appleby, Joyce, Elizabeth Covington, David Hoyt, Michael Latham, Allison Sneider, Joyce Appleby, Elizabeth Covington, David Hoyt, Michael Latham, and Allison Sneider. “Clifford Geertz (1973): Thick Description: Toward an Interpretive Theory of Culture” [2020].

Knowledge and Postmodernism in Historical Perspective: 310-323.

“If you want to understand what a science is, you should look in the first instance not at its theories or its findings, and certainly not at what its apologists say about it; you should look at what the practitioners of it do.” (Appleby et al., 2020, p. 1)

Core argument: phenomena that may be observed as identical may actually be deeply different, both in cause, meaning, practice, etc. – that is, just because we observe two identical outcomes does not suggest that we can characterize the two processes as identical

Particularly applied to culture: